The Comprenticeship Canvas

The community teaches. The student learns and applies their skills. Co-curricular learning, 18 hours over one semester.

Community partner _____ Semester _____

Comprentice(s) _____ Date _____

1 The community is the expert. 2 Show up every week. 3 The partner names the need. 4 Apply your skills, with dignity.

Who answers: PARTNER | COMPRENTICE | TOGETHER

STEP 1 — PARTNER

Who Teaches

The community partner

? What is your mission, and who do you serve?
? Who will mentor the student on site?
? Who else can the student learn from: staff, long-time volunteers, neighbors, people you serve (with consent)?
? How many comprentices can you host well? (2 to 5, usually one or two small groups)

STEP 3 · WEEKS 4–6 — TOGETHER

Listen First

? What will the student shadow and observe before acting?
? Who will they interview?
? Student: write three questions you will ask.

STEP 4 — TOGETHER

The Weekly Routine

? Day and time of the weekly 1.5-hour visit?
? How will the student get there?
? What happens if a week is missed?

4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15

Tick each week: 12 visits × 1.5 hours = 18 verified hours

START HERE — TOGETHER

What the Community Teaches

Everything else on this canvas serves this block.

? What does this community know that can't be learned in a classroom?
? Whose knowledge and history should the student hear first?
? By the last week, what should the student understand about this place and its people?
? How will the student show what they learned, in a way that credits the community?

STEP 5 — PARTNER LEADS

The Real Need

? Partner: what is one project you've wanted done but haven't had time for?
? Student: how will you apply your skills to it?
? What should the student not try to fix?

STEP 6 — TOGETHER

A Fair Exchange

PARTNER GAINS	STUDENT GAINS
? Steady help, a finished project, fresh ideas, a future volunteer?	? Skills, a mentor, career direction, belonging?

STEP 2 — COMPRENTICE

Who Learns

A small group of 2–3 students, or one student solo

? Who is in your group? What are your majors, and what skills will you apply here: languages, writing, design, data, caregiving, lived experience?
? What do you hope to learn from this community?
? What is one assumption you want to test?

STEP 7 — TOGETHER

Safety & Dignity

Agree before the first visit

- ☐ Orientation completed before the first visit
- ☐ Background check done, if the partner requires one
- ☐ No photos, audio or posts of people without written consent
- ☐ Names of people served are never recorded or shared
- ☐ Stories are told with consent and credit the community
- ☐ Site-specific rule: _____

STEP 8 — TOGETHER

What Lasts

? What will the student leave behind that the partner keeps using?
? How will you stay connected after 18 hours: volunteer events, mentoring the next comprentice, a reference, a check-in next semester?

AGREEMENT — TOGETHER

We Agree

We will learn from each other, show up every week, and build what the community asked for.

Partner _____

Comprentice(s) _____

Comprenticeship: learning with the community, not for it.

Fill in together at the first meeting. Revisit at midterm (Week 8). Free for any school or community partner to use and adapt.